

AWS IAM Last Accessed Report

To Begin with the Lab

Summary of the Lab

In this lab, the **AWS IAM Last Accessed** report was reviewed from the **IAM** console to understand which AWS services had been accessed by a user. The video showed that Last Accessed is built into each IAM identity and does not need to be downloaded as a CSV file like the credential report. A sample user initially showed access only to **Amazon S3**-related services, and then **Amazon EC2 Full Access** was attached to demonstrate how the service list expands in real time. The report displayed the allowed services and the last access time for each service, making it useful for reviewing permissions and identifying unused access. Finally, the lab confirmed that Last Accessed helps administrators apply the principle of least privilege by removing unnecessary permissions.

Understanding IAM Last Accessed

The **IAM Last Accessed** report shows which AWS services an IAM user, group, or role has actually used. It exists so administrators can see whether permissions are being used or if they should be removed to tighten security. Unlike the credential report, it is built directly into the IAM console and updates in real time. This makes it especially useful for improving permissions and reducing unnecessary access across users, groups, and roles.

Example:

A user named S3Admin originally shows access only to **Amazon S3** and **Amazon S3 Object Lambda**. After **Amazon EC2 Full Access** is attached, the report updates and shows **Amazon EC2**, **AWS CloudWatch**, **Elastic Load Balancing**, and related services. The administrator can then review which services are really needed and remove anything unnecessary.

Lab Steps

Step 1 – Open the IAM User Details

- Sign in to the AWS Management Console.
- Open **IAM** → **Users**.
- Select the target IAM user.

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IAM users (3) [Info](#)

An IAM user is an identity with long-term credentials that is used to interact with AWS in an account.

☐	User name	Path	Group	Last activity	MFA	Password age	Console last sign-in	Access key ID
☐	[redacted]	/	0	2 hours ago	-	10 days	2 hours ago	[redacted]
☐	[redacted]	/	0	4 hours ago	-	Yesterday	4 hours ago	-
☐	cf-shashank1	/	0	25 minutes ago	-	19 days	25 minutes ago	-

- Open the **Last Accessed** tab.

Step 2 – Review Existing Service Access

- Observe the list of AWS services already accessed by the user.
- Check the **Last accessed** column for each service.
- Review which services are currently allowed.

cf-shashank1 [Info](#) [Delete](#)

Summary

ARN: [redacted]hk1

Created: 2023-09-20T10:00:00Z (UTC-05:00)

Console access: Enabled without MFA

Last console sign-in: Today

Access key 1: [Create access key](#)

Permissions Groups Tags Security credentials **Last Accessed**

Last accessed information shows the services that this user can access and when those services were last accessed. Review this data to remove unused permissions. [Learn More](#)

Allowed services (451)

IAM reports activity for services and management actions. [Learn more](#) about action last accessed information. To see actions, choose the appropriate service name from the list.

Filter by services access history: No Filter

Service	Policies granting permissions	Last accessed
AWS IAM Access Analyzer	AdministratorAccess	Today
AWS User Notifications	AdministratorAccess	Today
AWS Free Tier	AdministratorAccess	Today
AWS User Experience Customization	AdministratorAccess	Today

Step 3 – Attach Additional Permissions

- Open the same IAM user.
- Click **Add permissions**.

cf-shashank1 info Delete

Summary

ARN: [arn:aws:iam::111111111111:user:cf-shashank1](#)

Created: June 08, 2026, 20:36 (UTC+05:30)

Console access: [Enabled without MFA](#)

Last console sign-in: [Today](#)

Access key 1: [Create access key](#)

Permissions | Groups | Tags | Security credentials | Last Accessed

Permissions policies (2) Remove Add permissions

Permissions are defined by policies attached to the user directly or through groups.

Search: Filter by Type: All types

☐	Policy name 🔗	Type	Attached via 🔗
☐	AdministratorAccess	AWS managed - job function	Directly
☐	IAMUserChangePassword	AWS managed	Directly

Permissions boundary (not set)

- Choose **Attach policies directly**.
- Select **AmazonEC2FullAccess**.
- Click **Next**.

Add permissions

Add user to an existing group or create a new one. Using groups is a best-practice way to manage user's permissions by job functions. [Learn more](#)

Permissions options

☐ Add user to group
Add user to an existing group, or create a new group. We recommend using groups to manage user permissions by job function.

☐ Copy permissions
Copy all group memberships, attached managed policies, inline policies, and any existing permissions boundaries from an existing user.

☒ **Attach policies directly**
Attach policies **directly** to a user. As a best practice, we recommend attaching policies to a group instead. Then, add the user to the appropriate group.

Permissions policies (2643) Refresh

Search: Filter by Type: All types 1 match

☐	Policy name 🔗	Type	Attached entities
☐	AmazonEC2FullAccess	AWS managed	6

Cancel **Next**

- Click **Add permissions**.

Step 4 – Review the Updated Last Accessed

- Return to the **Last Accessed** tab.
- Verify that new services now appear in the list.

The screenshot shows the AWS IAM console for user 'cf-shashank1'. A green notification bar at the top states '1 policy added'. The 'Last Accessed' tab is selected, showing a table of 'Allowed services (451)'. The table has three columns: 'Service', 'Policies granting permissions', and 'Last accessed'. The 'Amazon EC2' service is highlighted with a red box, showing it has 'AdministratorAccess and 1 more' policies. Other services listed include AWS User Notifications, AWS IAM Access Analyzer, AWS Free Tier, AWS User Experience Customization, AWS Organizations, and AWS Identity and Access Management.

Service	Policies granting permissions	Last accessed
AWS User Notifications	AdministratorAccess	Today
AWS IAM Access Analyzer	AdministratorAccess	Today
AWS Free Tier	AdministratorAccess	Today
AWS User Experience Customization	AdministratorAccess	Today
AWS Organizations	AdministratorAccess	Today
Amazon EC2	AdministratorAccess and 1 more	Today
AWS Identity and Access Management	IAMUserChangePassword and 2 more	Today

- Confirm that **Amazon EC2**, **AWS CloudWatch**, **Auto Scaling**, and other related services are shown.
- Review the last access information for each service.

Step 5 – Use the Report for Least Privilege Review

- Identify services that are no longer needed.
- Remove unnecessary permissions if required.
- Keep only the permissions that the user really needs.
- Use the Last Accessed output to refine IAM access.

Verification

- The **IAM Last Accessed** report was opened successfully.
- Service access for the IAM user was reviewed in the console.
- The report updated after **Amazon EC2 Full Access** was attached.
- Last access details for services were visible.
- The report was used to support least-privilege permission review.